UnitedHealthcare Pharmacy
Clinical Pharmacy Programs

Program Number	2026 P 2205-10
Program	Prior Authorization/Medical Necessity
Medication	*Skyrizi® (risankizumab-rzaa) injection *This program applies to the subcutaneous formulations of Skyrizi
P&T Approval Date	5/2020, 5/2021, 6/2021, 3/2022, 8/2022, 7/2023, 5/2024, 7/2024, 7/2025, 7/2026
Effective Date	10/1/2026

1. Background:

Skyrizi is an interleukin-23 antagonist indicated for the treatment of moderate to severe plaque psoriasis in adults and pediatric patients 6 years of age and older who are candidates for systemic therapy or phototherapy, active psoriatic arthritis in adults and pediatric patients 6 years of age and older, moderately to severely active Crohn's disease in adults, and moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis in adults.

2. Coverage Criteria[a]:

A. Plaque Psoriasis

1. **Initial Authorization**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Diagnosis of moderate to severe plaque psoriasis

-AND-

(2) **One** of the following:

(a) **All** of the following:

i. Greater than or equal to 3% body surface area involvement, palmoplantar, facial, genital involvement, or severe scalp psoriasis

-AND-

ii. History of failure to **one** of the following topical therapies, unless contraindicated or clinically significant adverse effects are experienced (document drug, date, and duration of trial):

a. Corticosteroids (e.g., betamethasone, clobetasol, desonide)
b. Vitamin D analogs (e.g., calcitriol, calcipotriene)
c. Tazarotene
d. Calcineurin inhibitors (e.g., tacrolimus, pimecrolimus)
e. Anthralin
f. Coal tar

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-AND-

iii. History of failure to a 3 month trial of methotrexate at maximally indicated dose, unless contraindicated or clinically significant adverse effects are experienced (document date and duration of trial)[b]

-OR-

(b) Patient has been previously treated with a systemic targeted immunomodulator FDA-approved for the treatment of plaque psoriasis as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document drug, date, and duration of therapy) [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Icotyde (icotrokinra), Ilumya (tildrakizumab), Otezla (apremilast), Siliq (brodalumab), Sotyktu (deucravacitinib), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab]

-OR-

(c) **Both** of the following:

i. Patient is currently on Skyrizi therapy as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document date and duration of therapy):

-AND-

ii. Patient has **not** received a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office, or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program (e.g., sample card which can be redeemed at a pharmacy for a free supply of medication) as a means to establish as a current user of Skyrizi*

-AND-

(3) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Icotyde (icotrokinra), Ilumya (tildrakizumab), Otezla (apremilast), Siliq (brodalumab), Sotyktu (deucravacitinib), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

-AND-

(4) Prescribed by or in consultation with a dermatologist

* Patients requesting initial authorization who were established on therapy via the receipt of a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office or any

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form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program **shall be required** to meet initial authorization criteria as if patient were new to therapy.

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

2. **Reauthorization**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **both** of the following criteria:

(1) Documentation of positive clinical response to Skyrizi therapy

-AND-

(2) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Icotyde (icotrokinra), Ilumya (tildrakizumab), Otezla (apremilast), Siliq (brodalumab), Sotyktu (deucravacitinib), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

B. Psoriatic Arthritis (PsA)

1. **Initial Authorization**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis

-AND-

(3) **One** of the following:

(a) History of failure to a 3 month trial of methotrexate at the maximally indicated dose, unless contraindicated or clinically significant adverse effects are experienced (document date and duration of trial)[b]

-OR-

(b) Patient has been previously treated with a systemic targeted immunomodulator FDA-approved for the treatment of psoriatic arthritis as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document drug, date, and duration of therapy) [e.g., adalimumab, Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Otezla (apremilast), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Sotyktu (deucravacitinib), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab]

-OR-

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(c) **Both** of the following:

i. Patient is currently on Skyrizi therapy as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document date and duration of therapy):

-AND-

ii. Patient has **not** received a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office, or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program (e.g., sample card which can be redeemed at a pharmacy for a free supply of medication) as a means to establish as a current user of Skyrizi*

-AND-

(3) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Orencia (abatacept), Otezla (apremilast), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Sotyktu (deucravacitinib), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

-AND-

(4) Prescribed by or in consultation with **one** of the following:

(a) Rheumatologist
(b) Dermatologist

* Patients requesting initial authorization who were established on therapy via the receipt of a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program **shall be required** to meet initial authorization criteria as if patient were new to therapy.

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

2. **Reauthorization**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **both** of the following criteria:

(1) Documentation of positive clinical response to Skyrizi therapy

-AND-

(2) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab), Cosentyx (secukinumab), Enbrel (etanercept), Orencia

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(abatacept), Otezla (apremilast), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Sotyktu (deucravacitinib), Taltz (ixekizumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

C. Crohn's Disease (CD)

1. **Initial Authorization for Maintenance Dosing**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Diagnosis of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease

-AND-

(2) **One** of the following:

(a) Patient has been approved for loading dose of Skyrizi under an active UnitedHealthcare medical benefit prior authorization for the treatment of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease

-OR-

(b) **Both** of the following:

i. Patient is currently on Skyrizi therapy for moderately to severely active Crohn's disease as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document date and duration of therapy):

-AND-

ii. Patient has **not** received a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office, or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program (e.g., sample card which can be redeemed at a pharmacy for a free supply of medication) as a means to establish as a current user of Skyrizi*

-AND-

(3) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Cimzia (certolizumab), Entyvio (vedolizumab), Omvoh (mirikizumab-mrkz), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

-AND-

(4) Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist

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* Patients requesting initial authorization who were established on therapy via the receipt of a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program **shall be required** to meet initial authorization criteria as if patient were new to therapy.

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

2. **Reauthorization**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **both** of the following criteria:

(1) Documentation of positive clinical response to Skyrizi therapy

-AND-

(2) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Cimzia (certolizumab), Entyvio (vedolizumab), Omvoh (mirikizumab-mrkz), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Tremfya (guselkumab), ustekinumab] for treatment of the same indication

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

D. Ulcerative Colitis (UC)

1. **Initial Authorization for Maintenance Dosing**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **all** of the following criteria:

(1) Diagnosis of moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis

-AND-

(2) **One** of the following:

(a) Patient has been approved for loading dose of Skyrizi under an active UnitedHealthcare medical benefit prior authorization for the treatment of moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis

-OR-

(b) **Both** of the following:

i. Patient is currently on Skyrizi therapy for moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis as documented by claims history or submission of medical records (Document date and duration of therapy):

-AND-

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ii. Patient has **not** received a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office, or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program (e.g., sample card which can be redeemed at a pharmacy for a free supply of medication) as a means to establish as a current user of Skyrizi*

-AND-

(3) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Entyvio (vedolizumab), Omvoh (mirikizumab-mrkz), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab, Zeposia (ozanimod)] for treatment of the same indication

-AND-

(4) Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist

* Patients requesting initial authorization who were established on therapy via the receipt of a manufacturer supplied sample at no cost in the prescriber's office or any form of assistance from the Abbvie sponsored Skyrizi Complete program **shall be required** to meet initial authorization criteria as if patient were new to therapy.

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

2. **Reauthorization**

a. **Skyrizi** will be approved based on **both** of the following criteria:

(1) Documentation of positive clinical response to Skyrizi therapy

-AND-

(2) Patient is not receiving Skyrizi in combination with another systemic targeted immunomodulator [e.g., adalimumab, Entyvio (vedolizumab), Omvoh (mirikizumab-mrkz), Rinvoq (upadacitinib), Simponi (golimumab), Tremfya (guselkumab), Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib), ustekinumab, Zeposia (ozanimod)] for treatment of the same indication

Authorization will be issued for 12 months.

[a] State mandates may apply. Any federal regulatory requirements and the member specific benefit plan coverage may also impact coverage criteria. Other policies and utilization management programs may apply.
[b] For Connecticut, Kentucky, and Mississippi business only a 30-day trial will be required.

3. Additional Clinical Rules:

- Notwithstanding Coverage Criteria, UnitedHealthcare may approve initial and re-authorization based solely on previous claim/medication history, diagnosis codes (ICD-10)

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and/or claim logic. Use of automated approval and re-approval processes varies by program and/or therapeutic class.
- Supply limits may be in place.

4. References:

1. Skyrizi [package insert]. North Chicago, IL: AbbVie Inc.; June 2026.
2. Menter A, Strober BE, Kaplan DH, et al. Joint AAD-NPF guidelines of care for the management and treatment of psoriasis with biologics. J Am Acad Dermatol. 2019;80:1029-72.
3. Singh JA, Guyatt G, Ogdie A, et al. 2018 American College of Rheumatology/National Psoriasis Foundation guideline for the treatment of psoriatic arthritis. Arthritis Care Res (Hoboken). 2019 Jan;71(1):2–29.

Program	Prior Authorization/Medical Necessity – Skyrizi® (risankizumab-rzaa)
Change Control	
5/2020	New program
5/2021	Annual review. Removed preceding month requirement from failure criteria. Removed prescriber requirement from reauthorization criteria. Removed drug documentation where only one drug is required. Reference updated.
6/2021	Added coverage criteria for patients previously treated with a biologic DMARD. Added clarification that submission of medical records is required documenting previous or current therapy with a biologic DMARD in order to bypass step through non-biologic therapies if claim history not available.
3/2022	Clinical coverage criteria updated to add active psoriatic arthritis. Updated reference.
8/2022	Clinical coverage criteria and background updated to add Crohn's disease. Added state mandate footnote to include Mississippi. Added Rinvoq as Janus kinase inhibitor example. Updated reference.
7/2023	Updated not receiving in combination language to targeted immunomodulator and updated examples.
5/2024	Annual review with no changes to coverage criteria. Updated state mandate footnote and references.
7/2024	Updated clinical coverage criteria and background to add ulcerative colitis. Updated active prior authorization verbiage under Crohn's disease with no change to clinical intent. Updated reference.
7/2025	Annual review with no change to coverage criteria. Updated drug examples and medical benefit loading dose language with no change to clinical intent. Updated references.
7/2026	Annual review. Updated background to include PsO and PsA for pediatric patients 6 years of age and older. Updated combination examples and language with no change to clinical intent. Updated references.

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